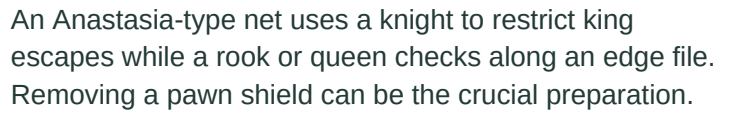


Anastasia mating nets

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

Previous move: 30.Kh2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

30...Qxh4#

30...Qxh4# Mate: queen on h4 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.